

Running your business on Zeno — every module, every role, start to finish.

From a customer's first quote to a fully reconciled, fully paid, fully filed month-end — written for every role in the org, not just admins.

Everything in this guide

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Who sees what, by default

Every role has a fixed list of modules it can see out of the box. An admin can adjust any of this per organization — see Section 18.

	Admin / Owner	Accountant	Sales	HR	Inventory	Staff
Home dashboard	●	●	●	●	●	●
Customers & Vendors	●	●	●	●	●	●
Deals	●	●	●	●	●	●
Quotes & templates	●	●	●	●	●	●
Invoices, templates & credit notes	●	●	●	●	●	●
Expenses	●	●	●	●	●	●
Expense claims	●	●	●	●	●	●
Bills & purchase orders	●	●	●	●	●	●
Items & Stock	●	●	●	●	●	●
Bank & M-Pesa	●	●	●	●	●	●
Accountant (ledger)	●	●	●	●	●	●
Fixed Assets	●	●	●	●	●	●
Reports	●	●	●	●	●	●
Payroll	●	●	●	●	●	●
Leave requests	●	●	●	●	●	●
Staff & Roles	●	●	●	●	●	●
Settings	●	●	●	●	●	●

ORIENTATION

This is the complete guide to running a business on Zeno — every module, in the order a real transaction actually moves through them, written for every role in the org, not just admins.

Roles Everyone

KEY CONCEPTS

- Each section covers one part of the system: what it's for, the ideas you need to understand it, and the exact steps to use it.
- Tags at the top of each section tell you which area of the business it belongs to — Sales, Money, Spending, Inventory, HR, Admin.
- The Roles line tells you who this section matters to. If your role isn't listed, you likely won't see that menu item at all — that's by design, not a mistake.
- Cross-references point to related sections, since almost nothing in Zeno works in isolation — a quote becomes an invoice, an invoice posts to the ledger, a payment clears a payroll liability.

NOTE

Zeno is built around one idea: the ledger is the hub. Every module — quotes, invoices, bills, payroll, assets — ultimately posts to the same double-entry ledger, so the rest of the system reads as one connected story instead of a list of separate tools.

How every part of Zeno connects

ORIENTATION**ARCHITECTURE**

Money moves through Zeno in a predictable line. Understanding this flow once means every other section in this guide slots into a picture you already have.

Roles Everyone

KEY CONCEPTS

- Contact → Quote → Invoice. A quote is drafted against a customer contact, sent, and — once accepted — converted into an invoice with one click. Line items, tax and category headings all carry across automatically.
- Invoice → Payment → Ledger. Recording a payment (manually, or via M-Pesa/card gateway) updates the invoice balance in real time and posts the receipt to Accounts Receivable and the paying account.
- Purchase Order → Bill → Payment. The mirror image on the spending side — a PO becomes a bill on receipt (partial receipt supported), a bill becomes a payment via Record payment, Pay via gateway, or a batched Payment Run.
- Payroll Run → Post to Ledger → Record Salary Payment. Posting a payroll run accrues the liability only; a separate "Record Salary Payment" step clears it against a real bank/M-Pesa account — cash never moves until that second step.

— Everything ends up in Accountant. Every document above posts a real double-entry journal entry — nothing in Reports or Analytics is calculated separately from that ledger.

SEE ALSO

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Roles & What Each One Sees

ADMIN

ORIENTATION

Every staff account has exactly one role, and every role has a fixed list of modules it can see. The sidebar isn't the same for everyone — that's intentional.

Roles Admin / Owner

KEY CONCEPTS

- Six built-in roles ship with Zeno: Admin (owner), Accountant, Sales, HR, Inventory, and Staff — plus any custom role an admin creates.
- Staff is deliberately narrow: self-service only — Home, Expense Claims, Leave Requests — and almost nothing else. That's the point, not an oversight.
- Admins can toggle exactly which modules any role — built-in or custom — can see, per organization, from Staff & Roles.
- The owner account always sees everything and can never be locked out, regardless of any toggle.

SEE ALSO

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Home Dashboard

OPERATIONS

DAILY-USE

The first thing everyone sees on login — a live snapshot of the business, tuned to your role.

Roles Everyone

KEY CONCEPTS

- Admins and accountants see the full picture: money owed, cash across every bank/M-Pesa account, money owed to vendors, VAT due to KRA, an invoice/quote status breakdown, and a 6-month income vs. expense chart.
- Everyone else sees a narrower, personal view — their own assigned documents and tasks, not the whole org's financial picture (when Data Segregation is on).
- A calendar surfaces upcoming due dates; a red banner surfaces anything overdue or needing attention today.



PREVIEW THIS SCREEN LIVE IN THE APP

Home dashboard — KPI cards, invoice/quote overview, upcoming due dates.

SEE ALSO

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Customers & Vendors

Contacts

SALES

SPENDING

CORE-DATA

One shared address book for everyone your business deals with — a contact can be a customer, a vendor, or both. Every quote, invoice, bill and credit note links back to a Contact here.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales · HR · Inventory

KEY CONCEPTS

- A contact's "kind" — customer, vendor, or both — decides which documents it can appear on.
- Every contact carries its own document history and account statement, plus an opening balance if you're migrating mid-year from another system.
- Vendors can save a default payout destination (M-Pesa, till, paybill) so bills don't require re-entering payment details every time.

SEE ALSO

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Deals

SALES

CRM

A lightweight pipeline for tracking sales opportunities before they become a real quote or invoice.

Roles Admin / Owner · Sales

KEY CONCEPTS

- Lead → qualified → proposal → negotiation → won/lost — a simple pipeline, not a full CRM.
- Entirely optional: you can quote or invoice a customer directly without ever creating a deal.

NOTE

Deals is deliberately kept separate and simple — it's for tracking a conversation, not for replacing the quote/invoice cycle itself.

Quotes & Quote Templates

SALES

MONEY

A quote is a formal, priced proposal for a customer. It can be drafted, sent, accepted, declined, or converted straight into an invoice.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales

KEY CONCEPTS

- Line items can be real catalog items, custom one-off lines, or category headings — a heading is a bold divider with no price, useful for grouping a quote into sections.
- Converting a quote preserves everything, including category headings, onto the resulting invoice.
- Quote Templates save a reusable layout — line items, notes, terms — so a common package doesn't have to be rebuilt from scratch every time.

STEP BY STEP

1 Draft the quote

+ Create → Quote, pick the customer, add lines or a saved template.

2 Send it

Mark as sent once shared with the customer.

3 Convert once accepted

"Convert to invoice →" — every line, tax setting and heading carries straight across.

SEE ALSO

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Invoices, Payments Received & Credit Notes

SALES

MONEY

Invoices are the billing document customers actually pay. Recording a payment updates its balance in real time; a credit note reverses part or all of one without deleting the record.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales

KEY CONCEPTS

- Every invoice line carries KRA-compliant VAT and is eTIMS-ready. Status moves Draft → Awaiting payment → Partly paid → Paid, or Overdue once the due date passes.
- Record payment logs money already received outside the app; Request via Gateway sends a real M-Pesa STK prompt straight to the customer's phone.
- A Credit Note can be raised even on an invoice that's already fully paid — that's the most common real reason to issue one (a refund on a paid invoice is normal, not a bug). Status reads Available → Partly applied → Fully applied, never "awaiting payment".
- Payments Received lists every payment ever applied to an invoice, whether entered manually or captured through a gateway.

SEE ALSO

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Expenses & Expense Claims

SPENDING

Everything money going out immediately, plus reimbursements for staff who pay out of pocket.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Inventory · Everyone (claims)

KEY CONCEPTS

- An Expense is paid immediately from a bank/M-Pesa/cash account, tagged with a category. A Kopo Kopo-routed till posts its flat transaction fee automatically alongside the expense.
- Expense Claims is the staff-facing side: any employee can file a claim with a receipt regardless of role — everyone in the org has this permission by default.
- Once approved, a claim is payable via Record payment or Pay via gateway, straight to the employee's M-Pesa number.

SEE ALSO

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Bills & Purchase Orders

SPENDING

A Bill is a vendor invoice you owe, paid later. A Purchase Order commits to buying before a bill even exists.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Inventory

KEY CONCEPTS

- Every bill line needs a category — except a tracked-inventory item, which posts to Inventory Asset automatically instead of showing a category picker.
- A Purchase Order converts into a bill once goods/services are received — partial receipt is supported, so one PO can convert across more than one bill.
- Payment Runs batch-pay several outstanding bills together instead of one at a time. Stuck Payouts (Gateway Payouts permission only) surfaces any gateway payout still pending confirmation from the provider.

SEE ALSO

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Items, Stock & Warehouses

INVENTORY

SPENDING

The catalog and stock ledger — everything your business sells or buys, with FIFO costing where tracking is on.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales · Inventory

KEY CONCEPTS

- "Track inventory" turns on automatic quantity-on-hand and FIFO cost as an item moves through invoices, bills and transfers. It can only be switched on or off cleanly while on-hand quantity is zero.
- Multiple warehouses hold separate stock counts for the same item; Stock Transfers move quantity between them with its own record, distinct from a sale or purchase.

SEE ALSO

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Bank & M-Pesa

MONEY

Every bank account, M-Pesa till and cash account, with reconciliation against real statements.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant

KEY CONCEPTS

- Reconciliation matches Zeno's booked transactions against a real statement's date and closing balance, line by line.
- A reconciliation left unfinished resumes exactly where it stopped — it never silently discards a freshly typed number for a stale one.
- Transfer between accounts moves money between your own accounts (e.g. Petty Cash → Main Bank) without it looking like income or an expense.

SEE ALSO

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Accountant

The ledger underneath everything

MONEY

The double-entry engine every other module posts to automatically. You'll rarely post directly here, except for a manual adjusting entry.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant

KEY CONCEPTS

- Chart of Accounts, journal entries, and Trial Balance live here, alongside Lock books (freeze a closed period), Cost centers, Uncategorized transactions and Budgets.
- Every account is one of five types — asset, liability, equity, income, expense — and that type can never change after creation, since it decides debit- or credit-normal behavior for every future posting.

SEE ALSO

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Fixed Assets

MONEY

Equipment, furniture, vehicles the business owns outright — plus intangible assets that amortize instead of depreciating.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant

KEY CONCEPTS

- Registering an asset without a paying account still saves it — marked "Not recorded" until "Record purchase" finishes posting it.
- Run Depreciation posts one period's straight-line entry at a time. Disposal (Sold, Scrapped, Traded in) asks which account received the proceeds, for a sale or trade.

Reports & Analytics

MONEY

INSIGHTS

Reports cover the standard accounting set — trial balance, P&L, VAT prep. Analytics adds a decision-making layer of charts.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · HR

KEY CONCEPTS

- Reports is the compliance layer — what you'd hand to an accountant or file with iTax (VAT3 mirrors what you'd file directly).
- P&L, Income vs Expense and Cost Center P&L can be filtered by business location, but only for lines actually tagged with one — the underlying AR/AP/VAT/bank lines are never location-tagged, so Balance Sheet, Trial Balance, Cash Flow stay org-wide.
- Analytics is the decision layer — revenue trend, top customers, top items/services, and quote conversion rate — reading real transaction data, with no locked or paywalled cards.

SEE ALSO

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Payroll

Runs, employees, loans & advances

HR

MONEY

Staff payroll runs, statutory rules and tax, and staff loans/deductions — a self-contained module for organizations paying employees through Zeno.

Roles Admin / Owner · HR · Accountant (ledger only)

KEY CONCEPTS

- PAYE, NSSF, SHIF and AHL calculate automatically from Rules & Tax, which carries an effective-from date so a mid-year statutory change never retroactively rewrites an already-run month.
- Posting is two deliberate steps: "Post to Ledger" accrues the liability only; "Record Salary Payment" — appearing once posted — asks which account the net pay actually left from and clears it. A run stays flagged NOT PAID until that second step.
- Loans is a longer-term staff loan recovered through payroll deductions over time. Salary Advances is the lighter, self-service version — a staff member can request one themselves, or a manager can issue one directly. Both recover the same way.

SEE ALSO

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Recurring Templates

MONEY

AUTOMATION

Set an invoice or bill to regenerate automatically on a schedule instead of re-entering it every cycle.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant

KEY CONCEPTS

- Due date can be a flat number of days, or a genuine "due at end of next month" calendar rule — not a coincidence of the day-count picked.
- "Issue automatically" sends it the moment it's generated; leave it off and it's created as a draft for review first.

SEE ALSO

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Staff & Roles

Who can see what

ADMIN

Where an admin creates staff accounts, assigns roles, and — critically — controls exactly which modules each role can see.

Roles Admin / Owner

KEY CONCEPTS

- Toggling a module for a role applies to everyone with that role, immediately — the permission matrix here is the literal source of truth for every sidebar item everyone in the org sees.
- Data Segregation (Settings) restricts staff to only documents assigned to them; the "View org-wide documents" permission grants a specific role (Accountant, by default) full visibility even with segregation on.

SEE ALSO

03

Settings & Billing

[ADMIN](#)

Org-wide configuration: company profile and branding, billing, payment gateways, and document numbering.

Roles Admin / Owner

KEY CONCEPTS

- Business Identity carries what appears on every document: name, logo, brand color, KRA PIN, invoice/quote numbering, footer/terms text.
- Billing shows the org's own trial/active status and lets an admin pay via the same M-Pesa/card flow customers use — "Pay now" only enables once the fee is actually due, to avoid paying twice by mistake.
- Payment Gateways connects M-Pesa Daraja or Kopo Kopo for automated, matched inbound payments — no manual reconciliation needed for gateway traffic.

SEE ALSO

[18](#)

End-to-End Walkthroughs

[ORIENTATION](#)[WORKFLOWS](#)

Three complete stories, start to finish, tying every section above into one continuous flow.

Roles Everyone

KEY CONCEPTS

- **A sale, start to finish:** a customer asks for pricing → Sales drafts a Quote → it's sent and accepted → Convert to invoice → customer pays via M-Pesa STK → payment posts to the ledger automatically → a Credit Note can still be raised later if a refund is needed, even though it's fully paid.
- **A purchase, start to finish:** Inventory raises a Purchase Order → vendor delivers, partially or fully → Convert to bill → Accountant records payment or batches it into a Payment Run → the line posts to Inventory Asset if the item is tracked, or to the expense category if not.
- **A payroll cycle, start to finish:** HR runs payroll for the month → PAYE/NSSF/SHIF/AHL calculate from Rules & Tax → Post to Ledger accrues the liability → Record Salary Payment clears it against the real bank/M-Pesa account used → the run flips from NOT PAID to PAID.

SEE ALSO

[02](#)[07](#)[08](#)[10](#)[16](#)

REFERENCE

Quick definitions for terms used throughout this guide.

Roles Everyone

Contact

One shared record for a customer, vendor, or both — the anchor every document links back to.

Category heading

A bold, zero-price divider line on a quote/invoice/bill used to group real lines into sections.

Post to Ledger

The step that turns a document (payroll run, invoice) into a real double-entry journal entry.

Reconciliation

Matching what's booked in Zeno line-by-line against a real bank/M-Pesa statement.

FIFO costing

Each stock purchase creates its own cost lot; a sale consumes the oldest lot first.

Data Segregation

An org-level switch that restricts non-elevated roles to only their own assigned documents.

ORIENTATION

This guide lives in the app itself under Documentation in the sidebar, so it's always available even without this PDF on hand. The in-app version only shows sections your role actually has access to; this PDF shows every module for reference. If something in the live system doesn't match what's written here, the in-app version is the current one — this PDF is a snapshot.

Roles Everyone